



# Parent Information Handbook

A practical guide for prospective and enrolled families

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Operating Hours: Mon-Fri, 7:30 am-6:00 pm

Age range: 3 months to 6 years

This handbook introduces Kinderland Educare and provides practical information about children's learning, care and everyday life at the centre. It is designed for both prospective and enrolled families.

The handbook should be read alongside your enrolment agreement, the current fee schedule and Kinderland's operational policies, which provide further detail about specific terms and procedures.

Information is reviewed as regulations, funding requirements and centre practices change. Families are informed when significant changes affect them. Current information is available at the centre, and our team is happy to answer any questions.

# Welcome to Kinderland

Tēnā koutou katoa, Assalamualaikum and welcome.

At Kinderland Educare, we recognise each child as a capable and unique learner. Every child brings their own identity, strengths, language, culture, relationships and ways of understanding the world. They also carry the hopes, dreams and aspirations of their whānau.

We build secure relationships, create meaningful learning opportunities and work closely with families as each child grows. Children are supported to communicate with confidence, solve problems, care for others and take increasing responsibility in everyday life.

## What families can expect

Kinderland Educare is a licensed education and care service with an Islamic Special Character. Our curriculum is guided by Te Whāriki and shaped by the children, families and communities who belong here.

Children learn through responsive relationships, play, conversation, movement, creativity, exploration and meaningful everyday routines.

Families can expect:

- A warm welcome and time for their child to become familiar with the people, spaces and daily rhythms of the centre.
- A primary care teacher who provides consistency during settling and important transitions.
- Learning environments that support independent exploration and learning alongside others.
- Respect for each child's identity, language, culture, family, personality and individual learning journey.
- Regular communication about care, wellbeing, interests, learning and development.
- Opportunities to share aspirations, knowledge, feedback and ideas.

## Our view of children

Children are competent and capable learners from birth. Their signals, preferences, ideas and efforts are recognised and respected.

Infants communicate through movement, facial expressions, sounds and close relationships. Toddlers explore ideas, boundaries and relationships as their independence grows. Older children increasingly plan, negotiate, explain, imagine and take responsibility.

Kaiako provide security, guidance and challenge at every stage. Children's mana and dignity are upheld through respectful communication, responsive care, emotional support and positive guidance. Teachers help children understand expectations, manage conflict, learn from mistakes and recognise their progress.

## Our team

Our kaiako have a strong understanding of child development across infancy, toddlerhood, and the preschool years, enabling

them to provide responsive, age-appropriate teaching that builds on each child's strengths, interests, and individual needs.

With over 80% qualified teachers, our team is committed to continuous improvement through regular professional development, professional growth cycles, and reflective practice. By working collaboratively and staying informed of current research and best practice, we provide high-quality education and care that supports every child to thrive.

# Our Islamic Special Character

Kinderland Educare is an Islamic Special Character centre. Our programme is gentle, welcoming and appropriate for each age group. Children from all backgrounds are valued members of our centre community.

## Values in everyday life

A central focus is building good character and respectful, considerate behaviour.

Children experience these values through everyday actions such as greeting others, speaking kindly, caring for shared spaces, showing patience, helping others, taking responsibility, expressing gratitude and valuing relationships.

These values align with manaakitanga, respect, reciprocity, compassion, fairness and responsibility. Together, they support children to grow as well-rounded, competent and confident people.

## Islamic and Arabic learning

Children experience age-appropriate sūrah, du‘ā, Islamic stories, oral language and exposure to Arabic. Learning is introduced through repetition, listening, conversation, peaceful group experiences and familiar routines.

Experiences grow in complexity as children develop. Infants may hear warm, familiar language and short recitations. Older children may remember more, discuss meaning, ask questions and connect their learning with everyday life.

Islamic learning is woven naturally throughout the day and remains responsive to each child's age, understanding, interest and wellbeing.

## Food and cultural practice

Food prepared at Kinderland is halal. Beef and pork are not included in the food we provide, and families are asked to keep lunch boxes free from these meats. This shared approach helps maintain cultural consistency across the centre.

# Your child's journey through Kinderland

Kinderland Educare operates across two purpose-built buildings within one secure campus. Each learning environment is thoughtfully designed to support the developmental stages of the children who learn there, while maintaining a strong sense of connection across our centre community.

## Little Wonderers (3 months – 2 years)

Little Wonderers is our infant learning environment, created for our youngest learners from three months to two years of age. Warm, responsive relationships provide the foundation for learning as infants build trust, communicate, explore their surroundings and develop a strong sense of belonging.

The environment supports uninterrupted play, movement, rest, sensory exploration and meaningful interactions with familiar adults who know each child well.

## Little Explorers (2 years – 3 years 6 months)

Little Explorers provides a rich environment where toddlers' growing curiosity, confidence and independence are nurtured through play, relationships and everyday experiences.

Children investigate, communicate, solve problems, develop friendships and increasingly participate in the routines of the day. Opportunities for interaction across the learning environments support natural tuakana-teina relationships, where children learn with and from one another through shared experiences.

## Discoverers (3 years 6 months – School)

Discoverers is our preschool learning environment. Children are supported to extend their thinking, collaborate with others, communicate increasingly complex ideas and take greater responsibility within the learning community.

Projects, creativity, literacy, mathematics, science, movement and cultural learning are woven through meaningful play and everyday experiences as children continue to build the knowledge, skills and dispositions that support lifelong learning.

## Individual Learning Journeys

Children move through our learning environments as they grow in confidence, capability and readiness. Age provides a general guide, while each transition is planned in partnership with families and responds to the individual strengths, relationships and developmental pathway of each child.

Transition visits allow children to become familiar with their new environment, teachers and routines. Wherever possible, children transition alongside familiar peers, helping them carry established relationships into the next stage of their learning journey.

## Transition to School

For most children, the transition to school begins around their fifth birthday. As children prepare for this milestone, teachers continue to foster independence, communication, curiosity, problem-solving, self-management and positive relationships. Families are kept closely involved throughout the process to ensure a confident and well-supported transition into primary school.

Children may continue attending Kinderland Educare until six years of age in accordance with our licence and the needs of the child and family.

# Starting and Settling

Beginning early childhood education is an important milestone for children and their families. We take time to build trusting relationships, get to know each child and work in partnership with families to support a positive start to their Kinderland journey.

## Before your child starts

Transition visits are available for children joining Kinderland. These visits are designed to help your child feel safe, confident, and excited about starting their early learning journey.

You know your child best, and we value the opportunity to learn from you. Before your child starts, we encourage you to share their interests, home languages, family, routines, health needs, favourite activities, and anything else that will help us get to know them and support them in the best possible way.

Every child settles differently, so we will work in partnership with you to develop a transition plan that reflects your child's individual needs. During your visits, you and your child will have time to meet our kaiako, explore the learning environment, become familiar with our daily routines, and begin building trusting relationships. Our goal is for you and your child to feel welcomed, supported, and a genuine sense of belonging from the very beginning.

## Primary care

Each child is supported by a primary care teacher who provides a consistent point of connection during settling. The primary care teacher works alongside the wider teaching team to support secure relationships with familiar, trusted adults across the centre.

## Familiar connections

Children are welcome to bring a comfort item from home, such as a blanket or soft toy. These familiar items can help strengthen the connection between home and Kinderland and support children as they settle into the day.

## Working together

Regular communication between home and the centre supports each child's wellbeing and learning. Conversations at drop-off and pick-up, learning stories, Individual Learning Aspirations and parent-teacher meetings provide opportunities to share information, celebrate progress and plan together.

We value your feedback and encourage you to share your ideas, questions, and suggestions at any time. Your feedback is an important part of our teachers' ongoing professional growth and reflective practice, helping us to continuously improve and provide the best possible education and care for your child.

## When families have concerns

We encourage families to raise concerns early. A teacher may be able to respond at the time, or a private meeting can be arranged with the primary care teacher, Head Teacher or Centre Manager.

Open communication helps us understand the concern, respond consistently and work towards a shared approach that supports your child.

# Daily Life at Kinderland

Daily routines provide children with familiarity, security and a sense of belonging. Teachers balance predictable parts of the day with flexibility for sleep, care needs, sustained play, weather, group interests and emerging learning. Infant routines are guided by each child's cues and information shared by families.

## What to bring each day

Please provide:

A clearly labelled bag.

Plenty of labelled spare clothing suitable for active and messy play.

A separate bag for used or soiled clothing.

A sunhat and suitable seasonal clothing.

Nappies and wipes.

Named bottles, formula or other agreed feeding supplies, where required.

Your child's lunch box on Wednesday.

Children learn through active, hands-on experiences that may involve water, mud, paint, sand or playdough.

Comfortable, practical clothing supports free movement and participation.

Lost items are placed in the Lost and Found area. Clearly labelled belongings are easier to return.

## Fresh, nutritious halal meals

Fresh, nutritious halal meals are prepared in-house for children which is included within the applicable fee arrangements. We use halal-certified meat and ensure that all other ingredients used in meal preparation are also halal. Current menus are available at the centre. Mealtimes are calm, social experiences where children can enjoy a range of foods, participate in conversation and develop increasing independence.

Please tell us about any allergies, medical dietary needs, food intolerances or significant food preferences. Where an allergy or medical risk is present, we will work with the family to develop an individual management plan.

## Lunch Box Day

Wednesday is Lunch Box Day for all children. Families are asked to provide a lunch box from home. Lunch Box Day provides children with the opportunity to practise everyday skills that support their transition to school, including carrying their lunch box, opening and closing containers, making choices about their food, and taking responsibility for their belongings.

Children are encouraged to independently take their lunch box out of their bag before mealtime and pack it away afterwards. These experiences help build confidence, independence, and self-help skills while supporting children to develop positive routines.

Families are asked to pack food that is safe, manageable, and appropriate for their child's age and stage of development. Lunch box food must follow Ministry of Health guidance for reducing food-related choking risks. This includes preparing high-risk foods safely, such as quartering grapes, removing bones, stones and large seeds, and modifying hard or difficult-to-chew foods.

Lunch boxes should be free from beef and pork. This supports an inclusive and respectful environment that recognises and values the cultural, religious, and dietary needs of all children and families within our centre.



## Bottle Feeding

Families are asked to provide bottles, formula, or milk as required for their child. All bottles, formula containers, and milk must be clearly labelled with the child's name. Feeding instructions should be kept up to date and

## Nappy changing routine

Families provide nappies and wipes for their child. Using familiar products from home supports each child's comfort and individual skin needs. Families are encouraged to check supplies regularly and ensure their child has enough nappies and wipes available for their enrolled hours.

All kaiako working across our learning environments are trained in Kinderland's nappy-changing procedures and follow safe hygiene practices at all times. Children's dignity, privacy, comfort, and wellbeing are central to every nappy-changing experience.

Kaiako communicate with children throughout the process, explain what is happening, respond to their cues, and encourage children to develop independence and participate in their own care as they become ready.

## Toilet learning

Toilet learning is planned individually in partnership with families. We respond to each child's readiness, family

communicated to kaiako to ensure each child's individual needs are supported.

The centre follows Ministry of Health and Ministry of Education guidance regarding the safe preparation, handling, storage, and feeding of bottles and milk.

aspirations, home routines, communication and health needs.

Children are encouraged with patience and respect. Accidents are treated as part of the learning process, and soiled clothing is managed hygienically. Please provide additional clothing and garments that your child can increasingly manage independently.

Toilet-learning plans are reviewed as each child's confidence and needs develop.

## Sleep and rest

Children have access to suitable sleep and rest spaces and equipment in accordance with licensing requirements. Sleep is guided by each child's needs, age, routines and information shared by their family.

Bedding is provided, stored and laundered by Kinderland in line with hygiene requirements. Individual arrangements can be made for a special blanket or comfort item.

# Attendance and collection

A physical attendance register is located in the foyer. The person dropping off and collecting your child must record their arrival and departure times each day.

The attendance register helps us account for every child throughout the day and in the event of an emergency. Regular attendance supports children's sense of belonging, wellbeing, continuity in learning, and the development of strong relationships within our centre community.

Please let us know if your child will be absent. We encourage children to attend their enrolled hours wherever possible, as consistent attendance helps us provide continuity of education and care and supports the Ministry of Education funding that enables us to maintain the high quality of our service.

For extended absences, additional information or documentation may be required in accordance with Ministry of Education funding requirements, such as an EC13 form completed by a licensed medical professional. We will discuss this with you if it applies.

## Arriving and leaving safely

Please bring your child into the centre where a kaiako will personally greet them and support a calm and settled handover at drop-off. At collection, a kaiako will say goodbye to your child and ensure they are safely released into your care, with a clear handover from staff.

For safety, internal classroom doors are opened only by a kaiako. This helps ensure children remain safely within the learning environment and do not exit unsupervised.

Families are responsible for supervising children including in the foyer and car park.

## Authorised collection

Children are released only to people authorised on the enrolment form or approved by a parent or guardian for a specific collection.

Please keep authorised collector information current. A person who is unfamiliar to staff must provide photo identification before the child can be released.

For a collector who is not listed on the enrolment form, written authorisation must be provided for that occasion. The message must include the collector's full name and be sent through an agreed written communication channel such as email or Snapchat. The collector must bring photo identification.

A new authorisation is required for each separate collection.

## Keeping information current

Please update the centre whenever telephone numbers, email addresses, home addresses, emergency contacts, custody arrangements or authorised collectors change.

Current information supports timely communication and the safe release of children.

# Learning, communication and partnership with whānau

Whānau are an essential part of our curriculum and each child's learning journey. A child's learning is connected to the relationships, languages, knowledge, faith, culture, and experiences that are valued at home. When families share what they notice, value, and hope for their child, we can better understand and support their learning and sense of belonging.

## Everyday communication

Regular conversations at drop-off and pick-up help teachers and families share information about routines, health, wellbeing, interests and significant events.

Snapchat is currently used for day-to-day communication, photographs and short videos where permission has been provided. Centre-wide information and important notices may also be shared by email. Families will be advised if communication platforms change.

If you would like more time to discuss your child's learning or wellbeing, we are happy to arrange a parent-teacher meeting.

## Learning Stories and Portfolios

Teachers document children's learning through learning stories, photographs, and examples of their work. These contributions are collected in each child's individual portfolio, creating a record of their learning journey and experiences at Kinderland. Portfolios are shared with families as a reflection of their child's time at the centre.

Learning stories are developed throughout the year to capture children's interests, strengths, progress, and meaningful learning experiences. Families are encouraged to read, respond to, and contribute to their child's portfolio, helping us build a shared understanding of each child's learning across both home and Kinderland.

## Individual Learning Aspirations

Individual Learning Aspirations (ILAs) are developed in partnership with families to reflect what is important for each child's learning and development. They bring together family aspirations with the strengths, interests, and emerging learning observed by kaiako.

These aspirations help guide the experiences, opportunities, and teaching strategies that support each child's growth and learning. ILAs are reviewed and updated over time as children develop, their interests change, and new learning emerges.

## Family participation

Families are encouraged to share their aspirations, ideas, home experiences, cultural knowledge and feedback throughout their child's time at Kinderland, including giving feedback on learning stories, contributing to and writing aspirations, and reading and responding to policy changes when they are shared.

We also welcome opportunities for parents and whānau to share their interests, skills or areas of expertise with the children, participate in centre events, and support excursions as parent helpers. Whether reading a favourite story, cooking, gardening or sharing your profession, these experiences enrich our curriculum and strengthen the connection between home and Kinderland.

## Policies and consultation

Families are informed about significant policy reviews and changes that affect the centre community. Current operational policies are available to view at the centre, and copies can be requested.

## Access to information about your child

Parents and guardians may request access to information relating to their own child in accordance with the Privacy Act 2020. Families may also request corrections to personal information where appropriate.

# Health, Safety and Wellbeing

The health, safety and wellbeing of children is central to everything we do. Kinderland Educare operates in accordance with the Education (Early Childhood Services) Regulations 2008 (as amended), the Ministry of Education Licensing Criteria for Early Childhood Education and Care Centres 2008 (as amended), and current public health guidance. Detailed operational procedures are available in the centre's policies.

## Illness

Please keep your child at home if they are unwell or unable to comfortably participate in the day's programme.

If your child becomes unwell while attending Kinderland, we will contact you or an authorised emergency contact so they can be collected as soon as practicable.

Please let us know about infectious illnesses, significant symptoms or changes to your child's health. For extended illness-related absences, an EC13 medical certificate will be required to maintain your child's enrolment.

## Medication

Medication is administered in accordance with our medication procedures and Ministry of Education requirements. Families are asked to provide written authorisation and ensure medication is supplied in its original, clearly labelled container.

Please discuss any regular medication, emergency medication or individual health needs with the teaching team.

## Immunisations

Immunisation information is requested as part of the enrolment process and should be updated whenever your child's immunisation status changes.

## Allergies and dietary requirements

Please let us know about any allergies, food intolerances or dietary requirements before your child starts and whenever information changes.

Where required, we will work with families to develop an individual health or allergy management plan.

## Sun protection

Please apply sunscreen before your child arrives each morning and provide a clearly labelled sunhat, along with your child's named sunscreen where a specific product is required.

## Emergencies

Kinderland maintains emergency procedures, emergency supplies and regular evacuation drills. In the event of an emergency, we will communicate with families using the contact details you have provided. Please ensure these details remain up to date.

## CCTV

CCTV operates in designated areas of the centre to support child safety and site security. Information is managed in accordance with the Privacy Act 2020 and the centre's privacy procedures.

## Child protection and positive guidance

Children's safety, wellbeing and dignity are at the heart of our practice. Kaiako use respectful relationships, positive guidance and supportive teaching strategies to help children develop self-regulation, confidence and positive relationships with others.

Kinderland follows its child protection responsibilities and responds to concerns in accordance with relevant legislation and centre procedures.



# Enrolment, Fees and Attendance

## Discussing your enrolment needs

Every family's needs are different. When you visit Kinderland, we will discuss the days and hours that work for your family, alongside current availability and the programme that best supports your child.

Your confirmed days and hours are recorded in your enrolment agreement.

## Changing hours or leaving Kinderland

Two weeks' written notice is required to withdraw your child or request a change to booked days or hours. Changes are subject to availability and are confirmed through updated enrolment documentation.

We value the relationships we build with children and whānau and appreciate the opportunity to be part of your child's learning journey. If you have any concerns or feedback about your experience at Kinderland, we encourage you to share this with us so we can listen, understand, and continue to provide the best possible support for your child and family.

## Fees

Our current fee schedule is available at the centre and will be explained during enrolment. One week's fees are payable in advance where applicable.

A late fee will apply if your child is left after their enrolled hours as we operate under strict Ministry of Education adult-child ratios.

## 20 Hours ECE

Kinderland offers 20 Hours ECE for eligible children from three years of age. Families complete the required documentation to confirm how their funded hours will be used.

Our team will explain how 20 Hours ECE applies to your child's enrolment and provide current information about any applicable fees.

## WINZ Childcare Subsidy

Families who may be eligible for a Work and Income Childcare Subsidy are encouraged to apply. Kinderland can provide the service information required to support your application.

Please speak with us if you would like assistance with the centre's part of the process.

## Absences

Please let us know when your child will be absent.

Regular attendance supports strong relationships, a sense of belonging and continuity in learning.

Extended absences may require additional information or documentation in accordance with Ministry of Education funding requirements, such as an EC13 form signed by a licensed medical professional. We will discuss this directly with you where it applies.

## Family holidays

After six months of enrolment, families may access up to two weeks of holiday each calendar year at 50% of the applicable fees.

Please notify us by email in advance so your holiday dates can be recorded and the appropriate fee applied.

## Public holidays and closures

Kinderland is open Monday to Friday from 7:30 am to 6:00 pm and is closed on statutory public holidays.

Any additional or emergency closures will be communicated directly to families through our usual communication channels.

## We're here to help

Fees, funding and subsidies can vary depending on your child's age, enrolled hours and individual circumstances. Our team will explain the current arrangements that apply to your family during enrolment and whenever your circumstances change.

# Policies, Feedback and Complaints

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## Information for families

Kinderland provides families with access to information about the operation of the centre, including our licence, ERO report, policies and procedures, fees, teacher qualification information, Ministry of Education funding information and other documentation required under the licensing criteria.

Current information is available at the centre, and families are welcome to request copies or ask for help locating or understanding a document.

Our policies and procedures are regularly reviewed, and families are invited to contribute feedback and participate in consultation when relevant.

## Education Review Office

Kinderland Educare is evaluated by the Education Review Office (ERO). Our most recent Akarangi | Quality Evaluation was published in October 2025.

Previous ERO findings have recognised strengths in our relationships with children and whānau, culturally responsive practice, learning environments and support for children's confidence, belonging and learning.

[View Kinderland Educare's current ERO information and reports →](#)

## Feedback and concerns

We welcome feedback and encourage families to raise questions or concerns early. Open communication gives us the opportunity to understand what has happened, respond appropriately and work together towards a resolution.

You are welcome to request a private meeting and bring a support person when discussing a formal concern.

## Complaints

Our full complaints procedure, including current licence status, is available at the centre.

# A final word

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Thank you for choosing Kinderland Educare to be part of your child's early learning journey.

We value the knowledge, aspirations and experiences each family brings and look forward to working alongside you as your child learns, grows and discovers their place in the world.